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A pilgrim but a tourist too: re-examining the contemporary links

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ABSTRACT
The discussion about the definition of 'tourism' and 'pilgrimage' has been intensified over the time. This paper has as its main goal to understand how pilgrimage routes are perceived and experienced by contemporary pilgrims. The Camino de Santiago has been taken as a case study, as it is one of the main European pilgrimage routes. The methodological strategy applied is quantitative through a structured questionnaire carried out with 414 pilgrims. The model proposed for the analyses allowed to characterise the pilgrims who do the Camino de Santiago. The study identifies and evaluates four main motivations that lead to the Camino de Santiago and that could predictably be extrapolated to other pilgrimage routes: well-being and pleasure; spirituality and avoidance; socialisation and entertainment; and religious motives.

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Pilgrimage; tourism; tourist profile; Way of Saint James; religious tourism

1. Introduction

The discussion about the definition of 'tourism' and 'pilgrimage' has been intensified over the time (Collins-Kreiner, 2018; Polus et al., 2022). However, the classification of 'pilgrims' and/or 'tourists' is not conclusive (Kim et al., 2019; Tsironis, 2022) and is still a challenge despite the many attempts to categorise and provide definitions (Di Giovine & Choe, 2019). In fact, according to Mora-Torres et al. (2016), the origin of religious tourism studies dates back in the 70's, starting with research about pilgrimage (Turner & Turner, 1978), and questions about the relationship between the sacred and the profane (Eliade, 1998).

In spite of the efforts to clarify the complex controversy about the dichotomy between pilgrimage and tourism (Olsen & Timothy, 2006), today the limits between these concepts are blurred. On the one hand, both terms have been evolving (Millán Vázquez & y Pérez, 2017) and, on the other hand, they have interrelations and structural and experiential similarities (Feldman, 2017; Graburn, 2001) that are emphasised (Pereiro, 2019).

It was traditionally thought that pilgrimage was traditionally thought to be a phenomenon very different from tourism (López, 2013), since while it was associated with religion and spiritual centres, tourism was more linked to fun (Pereiro, 2019). However, as it will be shown in this paper, pilgrimage is a term and a practice that has evolved and gone from having a purely religious origin to being designed simultaneously as a secular and leisure activity (Badone & Roseman, 2004).

The socio-cultural changes in the twentieth and twenty-first centuries, i.e. the development of mass tourism and transport, the secularisation, the commercialisation and globalisation of societies and life as well as the blurring of the boundaries between tourism-pilgrimages in many aspects have influenced on pilgrimage centres (Sołjan & Liro, 2022).

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In fact, tourism and pilgrimage are actually two social phenomena that embrace such quite similar dynamics that it can be said that modern tourism may come from the first pilgrimages (Collins-Kreiner, 2010a). Thus, pilgrimages embody the intersection of various cultural, social, political, economic and/or environmental dimensions of society (Di Giovine & Choe, 2019).

This paper approaches the study of the relationship between tourism and current pilgrimage with its convergences and divergences, taking as its starting point the discussion raised by Smith (1992) of framing the pilgrim-tourist. In order to achieve this, an empirical work focused on understanding how sacred places are perceived and experienced by modern pilgrims is carried out: Are they identified as pilgrims or tourists? How can we distinguish these identity categories?

For this, the Camino de Santiago has been taken as a case study because it is one of the most popular European pilgrimage routes (Pereiro, 2019), which has also managed to revive and consolidate itself as an authentic mass event in recent decades (Lois González, 2013). The fieldwork has been made up of 414 online surveys from pilgrims in the route in Galicia covered by this study who had done the 'Camino de Santiago' at least once to detect this process of dedifferentiation between tourist and pilgrim, while discovering the multiple and mixed motivations, as well as their profile and the main activities they perform.

2. Critical review of the pilgrim-tourist dichotomy: the dedifferentiation

There are several researchers who have conceptualised the relationship between tourism and pilgrimage as a dichotomy (Smith, 1992; Timothy & Olsen, 2006). But, after a review of the state of the art according to Mora-Torres et al. (2016) two positions emerge that seem opposite: the first establishes a clear differentiation between the categories of tourist and pilgrim; and the second, denying the separation in the mentioned categories. Within the first position, the works of Smith (1992), Cohen (1979), Morinis (1992) and Vukonic (1996) are particularly representative; while within the second the works of MacCannell (1973), Graburn (2012) and Eade (1992) stand out.

In particular, Smith's (1992) proposal goes beyond seeing the polarity between tourism and pilgrimage as two irreconcilable forms of travel, and places them on a continuum or gradation of sacredness and secularity as opposite endpoints in order to explain their interrelationship (Figure 1), which goes from the pious pilgrimage based on faith, to strictly secular tourism.

Smith (1992) thus outlines the differences between a secular and religious traveller, in their continuous pilgrimage-tourism as opposite polarities, and describes five points depending on their religious or profane motivations and activities: (a) pilgrim (b) pilgrim > tourist, (c) pilgrim = tourist, (d) pilgrim < tourist and (e) secular tourist.

Traditionally, however, the pilgrim has been identified more as a religious traveller and the tourist as someone with a more superficial immersion in the local community. In an intermediate position, or as a central space, religious tourism would be placed, where we can make a difference between a traveller who is more pilgrim than tourist, a tourist who is as pilgrim as tourist, or a tourist who is more tourist than pilgrim. In this central terrain is where, according to Blom et al. (2008), most of the pilgrims and tourists are located today.

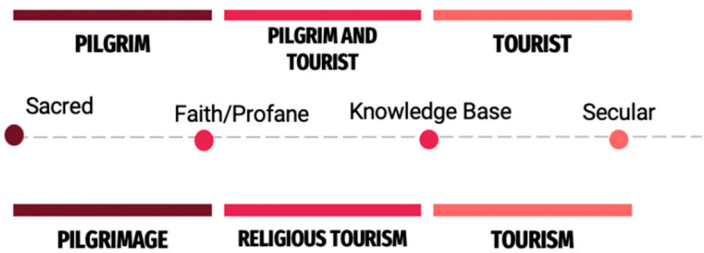

Figure 1. Relationship between tourist and pilgrim. Source: Own elaboration from Smith (1992).

However, the distinction between tourism and pilgrimage, pilgrim tourist, or secular and sacred has become much more complex (Kim et al., 2019). Since the early 90s it has been recognised that the connection between the two phenomena is unclear (Bowman, 1991; Eade, 1992) and attention has begun to been paid to secular sites and non-religious factors involved in the pilgrimage (Badone, 2014; Badone & Roseman, 2004; Coleman & Eade, 2004; Margry, 2008).

Thus, the differentiation between pilgrims and tourists has decreased as, according to Turner and Turner (1978, p. 20), 'a tourist is half a pilgrim and a pilgrim is half a tourist'. When analysis is based on dichotomies, it is almost impossible to achieve a total consensus in defining terms such as 'pilgrimage' or 'religious tourism' (Tsironis, 2022).

Thus, unlike the conceptualisation of the continuum proposed by Smith (1992), it is suggested that the roles and identities of pilgrims should be presented as multidimensional, diverse and multifaceted elements (Liro, 2021). It is argued that pilgrimage should be defined holistically, encompassing both traditional religious pilgrimage and modern secular travel (Collins-Kreiner, 2018).

Current discussions indicate that it is increasingly difficult to distinguish pilgrimage from tourism in modern society (Amaro et al., 2018; Lois González, 2013) or use the words 'pilgrim' and 'tourist' in a mutually exclusive way, as their meanings are continuously built and rebuilt and intertwined (Kim et al., 2019).

In fact, there is much of secular and tourist in pilgrimages considered religious, as there are also true profane pilgrimages (Pereiro, 2019). In this complex reality, the changing motivations, interests and activities of visitors are shown and it is recognised that 'the rigid dichotomies between pilgrimage and tourism, or pilgrims and tourists, no longer seem defensible' (Badone & Roseman, 2004, p. 2).

Today, pilgrimage in the most religious sense, in contact with tourism, is redefined and becomes a complex and polysemic social phenomenon (Feldman, 2017; Sousa et al., 2017), more spiritual, touristic and post-secular. Instead of conceiving pilgrims and tourists as different and antagonistic, by representing the sacred and the profane, the idea begins to be taken that the same subject can be a pilgrim and a tourist, or that the pilgrim, in addition to entailing to a large extent a sacred dimension, also carries with it a dimension that refers to various cultural phenomena linked to consumption, leisure and free time (Fabreau, 2019).

In the contemporary world, the concept of pilgrimage is re-emerging through tourism with a new identity, beyond the narrow window of religious and/or spiritual tourism, or visits to formal or secular pilgrimage sites (Polus et al., 2022). From this perspective, as Badone and Roseman (2004) argue, one should look for the intersections that occur when, for example, profane travellers are fascinated by the sacred and the cases in which religious travellers are fascinated by culture, heritage, nature, landscape, etc. (Øian, 2019).

In this sense, there are several authors who categorise pilgrimage as a post-secular phenomenon (Lois González, 2013; Nilsson & Tesfahuney, 2016; Øian, 2019), when they refer to processes in which faith, religion and spirituality are reclaiming secular spaces (Lois González, 2013; Nilsson & Tesfahuney, 2016). In fact, more and more the gap between religion and spirituality is broader and, in this case, pilgrims define their journey as something spiritual in order to maintain a distance from the Church (as an institution), but at the same time claim to 'believe in something' (Cazaux, 2019).

From this perspective, pilgrimage and tourism can be seen as forms of mobility through which a transition from the sphere of the prCOofane to that of the sacred takes place (Graburn, 2012; MacCannell, 1999). As early as 1976, MacCannell introduced pilgrimages into a tourist context and suggested that tourists are a modern form of pilgrims. Therefore, there are good reasons to cling to MacCannell's analogy between the pilgrim and the tourist as subjects who pursue the unknown and the extraordinary.

As pointed out by Collins-Kreiner (2010a), the religious and the secular spheres of tourism are rapidly emerging, as religious tourism assumes a more prominent market niche in international tourism. Agreement in this area cannot be reached unless we take into account the specifics of the ontological level distinguishing between the sacral (religious, holy) and secular (profane,

mundane). We should delve into the motivation of the traveller as well as the ontological anchoring of the religious, spiritual and secular spheres (Jirásek, 2014).

The use of the concepts 'sacred' and 'secular' has become problematic in relation to the classic definitions of Eliade (1998), particularly in reference to sharply contrasting polarisations. To reach agreement in this area, it is essential to consider the ontological distinction between the sacred and secular levels. Eliade [1998] identified these dimensions, emphasising the profound difference between the sacred, revealed in the hierophany, and the profane. These worlds are separated but interconnected by a boundary, allowing transition between them (Jirásek, 2014). The characteristics of the profane and the sacred involve spatial elements, such as cathedrals that symbolically link 'heaven and earth', and temporal aspects, including sacred festivals distinct from everyday time.

These dimensions of the human way of being were discerned by Eliade [1998], when he pointed out the fact that the sacred manifests in the process of hierophany as something wholly different from the profane. These two worlds are delineated by a boundary where they differ, yet join, and where it is possible to cross from one world to another. The characteristics of the profane and the sacral involve space (cathedrals and towers interconnecting 'heaven and earth' as the symbolical centre of the world, where the ritual connection with the world of transcendence was feasible) as well as time (the sacred time of holidays, mostly periodically repeated, different from the concept of everyday time).

All of the above has led to the emergence of an approach to research in tourism and pilgrimage, which claims convergence and dedifferentiation, which postulates that the divergences between tourism and traditional pilgrimage are being reduced, while numerous similarities are becoming evident, which is why there is a tendency towards integration. Trips to pilgrimage centres are often characterised by a combination of characteristics typical of both pilgrimage and tourism (Collins-Kreiner, 2010).

That is why pilgrimage can be considered as tourism and vice versa (Badone & Roseman, 2004; MacCannell, 1973; Timothy & Olsen, 2006; Wickens, 2002), since, in a way, in a framework dominated by the interpermeability of the sacred-profane and spirituality-materiality (Della Dorra, 2018) these categories are indistinguishable (Collins-Kreiner, 2010b; Damari & Mansfeld, 2016; Norman, 2012) or one could even add that they are all *de facto* tourists (Gomes et al., 2019) if we strictly attend to their definition.

In short, the analytical distinction between pilgrimage and tourism does not seem to be either fruitful (Di Giovine, 2013) or 'sustainable in the changing world of postmodern travel' (Badone & Roseman, 2004, p. 2). We should delve into the motivation of the traveller as well as the ontological anchoring of the religious, spiritual and secular spheres (Jirásek, 2014).

The most recent studies demonstrate the difficulties of establishing clear boundaries around these categories of travel and, among the polarities of this continuum labelled as sacred versus profane, lies an almost infinite range of possible combinations, reflecting the multiple and changing motivations of travellers (Collins-Kreiner, 2018).

The conversion of pilgrimage into a 'secular ritual' whose complexity cannot be approached from the categories of pilgrimage or tourism, but it is more appropriate to present it as a practice of resignifying mobility based on experimentation free of cultural, religious or spiritual senses (Herrero Pérez, 2008).

3. Methodology

This paper has as its main goal to understand how pilgrimage routes are perceived and experienced by contemporary pilgrims. Thus, through the analysis of the experience that individuals have when they move to certain religious sites, it is possible to understand the convergence between tourism and pilgrimage, i.e., the de-differentiation between these two forms of travel (Mora et al., 2018).

The Camino de Santiago has been taken as a case study, as it is one of the main European pilgrimage routes and the first great example of the contemporary recovery of mass pilgrimage in the West (Lois González & Santos, 2015). Below are the specific objectives defined:

Table 1. Sociodemographic profile of the sample.

Sociodemographic Variables	*N*	%		*N*	%
Gender			Age		
Male	217	52.4	18–24	62	15.0
Female	197	47.6	25–34	57	13.8
Total	414	100	35–44	46	11.1
Country			45–54	73	17.6
Spain	308	74.4	55–64	99	23.9
Europe	37	8.9	65 or more	77	18.6
International	69	16.7	Total	414	100
Total	414	100	**Employment status**		
Educational level			Self-employed	60	14.5
Illiterate	1	0.2	Unemployed	11	2.7
Elementary	7	1.7	Retired	99	23.9
Secondary School (Vocational Training/High School diploma)	102	24.6	Employed	168	40.6
University Degree	304	73.4	Student	76	18.4
Total	414	100	Total	414	100
Socioeconomic level					
Low	56	13.5			
Medium-low	57	13.8			
Medium	210	50.7			
Medium-high	80	19.3			
High	11	2.7			
Total	414	100			

Source: Own elaboration.

1. Studying the motivations that lead to the Camino de Santiago
2. Analysing the analytical distinction between pilgrim-tourist in the Camino de Santiago

The methodological strategy applied is quantitative through a structured online questionnaire aimed at pilgrims who, as a requirement, had done the Camino de Santiago at least once in the last 5 years. The data was collected in 2021 and the dissemination of the survey was mainly carried out through associations and institutional social networks in each rout. The questionnaire is based on previous studies on tourist motivation (Bond et al., 2015) and religious tourism in pilgrimage centres (Liro et al., 2018a) and has been analysed with the SPSS program. Finally, the resulting sample consists of 414 pilgrims. Table 1 then sets out the sociodemographic variables of the respondents. As a summary of the profile of the respondent, they are mainly Spanish (74.4%), the sample is balanced between men (52.4) and women (47.6), the group between 55and 64 years old (23.9) stands out slightly by age, active workers (40.6), with a medium socioeconomic level (50.7) and with a higher education (73.4).

4. Case study: the Camino De Santiago as a polysemic phenomenon

In the Western world, the route that ends in Santiago de Compostela (Galicia, Spain) (Figure 2) has acquired international reputation in recent years. Since the Middle Ages, the Camino de Santiago has been one of the greatest pilgrimage routes of Christianity that runs through the main Spanish and even European cities (Figure 3).

In 1987, The Way received the distinction of European Cultural Itinerary, due to its already mentioned importance as a historical and cultural link in the history of Christianity, and its undeniable universal value (Millán Vázquez & y Pérez, 2017). In 1993 its recognition reached a universal dimension, being declared World Heritage Site by UNESCO. At the same time, the Holy Year[1] 1993 is promoted, in which an ambitious campaign is launched through a secular and commercial version of the 'Xacobeo Holy Year'. This 'reinterpretation' of the religious, towards a feeling further removed from the sacred, even with the maintenance of a spiritual background, will remain to this day.

Figure 2. Map of pilgrimage routes to Santiago. Source: Map provided by Google Maps.

The first Xacobeo 93 was followed by Xacobeo 99, Xacobeo 2004, Xacobeo 2010 and Xacobeo 21-22. The pilgrimage to Compostela was, in this sense, an example of 'prototourism' that, today, has created a new model of global tourist-cultural route: 'Camino de Santiago S.A.' (Pereiro, 2019). Mikaelsson argues that Santiago de Compostela is probably the best example of the post-secular trend towards a spiritual destination. This change opened a new 'era of tourism' that does not break with the past, but involves a repositioning of its traditional image, that is, from strictly religious symbols (pilgrimage and holy city) to a broader cultural sense (marked by the celebration of modern Jacobean years).

The route to Compostela is experiencing a moment of splendour and is configured as an authentic mass event (Lois González & Lopez, 2012). Since 2011, the figures have increased substantially each holy year, reaching more than 300,000 annual pilgrims since 2017 (Figure 4). However, this recovery cannot be understood as a result of the participation of pilgrims in the religious beliefs in which this ritual is inscribed (even if it is so in the case of some of them), but must be seen as the expression of values of modern and secularised society such as tourism, the interest in traditions and the past or new forms of spirituality (Herrero Pérez, 2008).

Figure 3. Map of pilgrimage routes to Santiago. Source: Own elaboration in MapaCreator.

5. Analysis and discussion of results

5.1. Study of the motivations that lead to do the 'Camino de Santiago'

At present, the Camino de Santiago stands out for its ability to adapt to current times, flowing between religion and a wide spectrum of motivations ranging from the spiritual to those related to sport (Lois González & Santos, 2015). Likewise, since people usually travel for a set of non-exclusive reasons that complement their main purpose, participants were also given the option of multiple responses regarding their motivations. These participants were the pilgrims who were specifically asked about their motivations, and the central value of each item was calculated in relation to the total.

As can be seen in Figure 5, 6.16% of those polled has answered that the reason has been to *rest/relax/disconnect*, whose value is framed in the range of *very important* reasons. It should also be

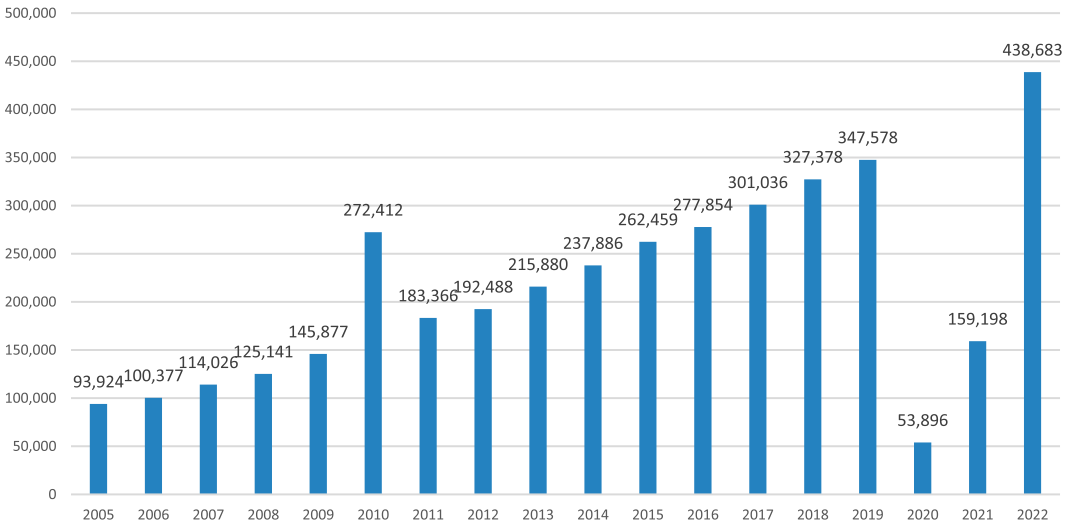

Figure 4. Evolution of the number of pilgrims based on the Compostelas. Source: Own elaboration based on data from the Pilgrim's Office (2022). *Not all pilgrims decide to carry the pilgrim's credential and collect the Compostela, a document accrediting having completed the pilgrimage at the Pilgrim's Office in Santiago de Compostela.

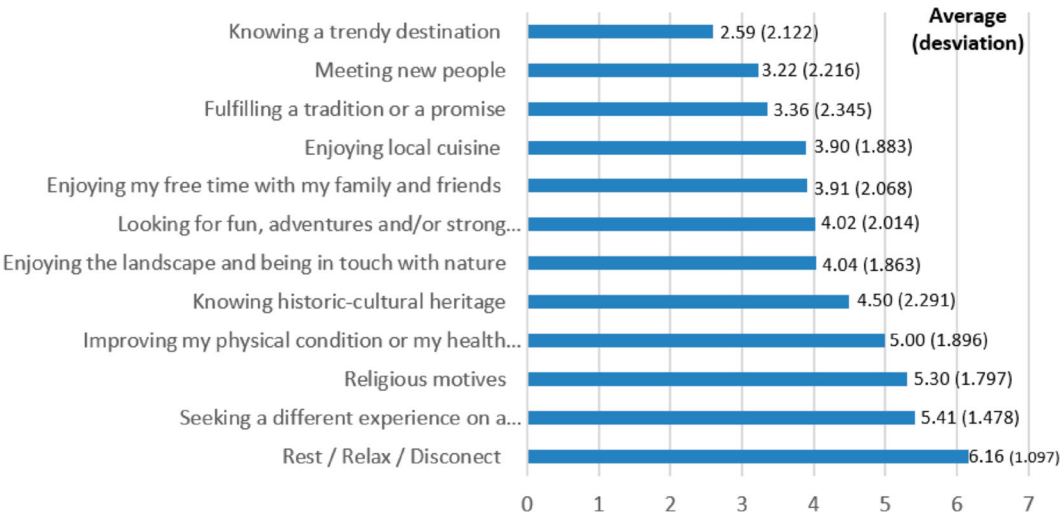

Figure 5. Motivations to do the Camino de Santiago. Source: Own elaboration.

added that *fulfilling a tradition or a promise, meeting new people and knowing a trendy destination* are the variables with the *lowest scores* and, therefore, where *more disparity of opinions* is noticed since *the standard deviation is the highest*.

The success of the Camino de Santiago is based on the fact that these new travellers mix and match religious or spiritual motivations with tourist motivations, such as the search for different landscapes, the need for relaxation, escape, etc. (Lois González & Santos, 2015).

According to the results, and with the exception of religious reasons, the rest of the variables among which the responses are distributed seem to coincide with the profile of a new pilgrim-tourist, who mixes the search for spiritual experiences with the enjoyment of the landscape and the culture, rest and relaxation, with Santiago as a meeting point between traditional religion and the post-secular.

However, the average reached for these religious reasons invites us to reflect on whether a relevant part of the sample would fit a pilgrim profile that is more removed from leisure and rest, as exposed in other research (Mora et al., 2018). In order to synthesise the motivations that lead to this pilgrimage route, an exploratory factor analysis has been applied, as it is considered as a statistical technique that allows reducing a large number of variables used in the collection of data in a smaller latent number of factors (Hair et al., 1999). Thus, the statistical analysis carried out shows the existence of four factors or dimensions that make up the variables that categorise the motivations to walk the Camino de Santiago, as shown in Table 2:

As can be seen in Figure 6, first of all, there is Factor 1, which brings together 4 variables: *improving my physical condition or my health through exercise, knowing its historical-cultural heritage, enjoying the landscape and direct contact with nature and meeting new people*. Based on these variables, it has been decided to label this component as 'well-being and pleasure'. Secondly, Factor 2 embraces 3 variables *rest/relax/disconnection, seeking a different experience on a personal/psychological level and Looking for fun, adventures and/or strong experiences*. Thus, it has been chosen to call it 'spirituality and evasion'. Thirdly, Factor 3 includes 3 variables that refer to *enjoying free time with my family and / or friends, enjoying local cuisine and Knowing a trendy destination*. Thus, this factor is renamed 'socialization and entertainment'. Fourthly and finally, Factor 4 groups 2 variables associated with *religious reasons* and *fulfilling a tradition or a promise*. Thus, this factor is labelled as 'religious motives'.

Likewise, the table shows the results around the mean and standard deviation of the four factors described above. The component that includes a more relevant importance in the sum of the different motivations of the surveyed sample is that of *well-being and pleasure*, since its average

Table 2. Exploratory Factor Analysis of the motivations to make the path.

Variables	Factors			
	F1	F2	F3	F4
Improving my physical condition or my health through exercise	0.647			
Knowing historic-cultural heritage	0.829			
Enjoying the landscape and being in touch with nature	0.689			
Meeting new people	0.432			
Rest / Relax / Disconnection		0.674		
Seeking a different experience on a personal/psychological level		0.777		
Looking for fun, adventures and/or strong experiences		0.548		
Enjoying my free time with my family and friends			0.835	
Enjoying local cuisine			0.632	
Knowing a trendy destination			0.525	
Religious reasons				0.638
Fulfilling a tradition or a promise				0.798
Number of items	4	3	3	2
% Explained Variance	27.059	13.618	10.181	8.994
% Cumulative Variance	27.059	40.677	50.858	**59.852**
In total, the four factors represent 60% (59,852%) of the total variance explained.				
Barlett Sphericity Test	957.23(gl = 66; Sig = 0,000)			
KMO Index	0.747			
Cronbach's alpha	(13 Items) 0.682			

F1: Wellness, pleasure and social interaction; F2: Escape and emotional exploration; F3: Leisure and delight; F4: Religious motivations.
Source: Own elaboration.

accounts for 4.87 nearly 5, which corresponds to the '*important*' score, and its standard deviation is very distant and low, 1.1, so there is more *homogeneity of opinions* regarding the importance of motivations in this grouped sample. It is followed by the factor that collects *spirituality and avoidance*, with an average of 4.74 and a standard deviation of 1.42. On the other hand, the component that contains the greatest *disparity of opinions* regarding the importance given to motivations is that of religious motives, since its average is the lowest of the components and its standard deviation is the highest.

In order to continue to research into determining the most relevant motivations for pilgrims on the route to Santiago de Compostela and corroborate the data previously presented, the analysis of

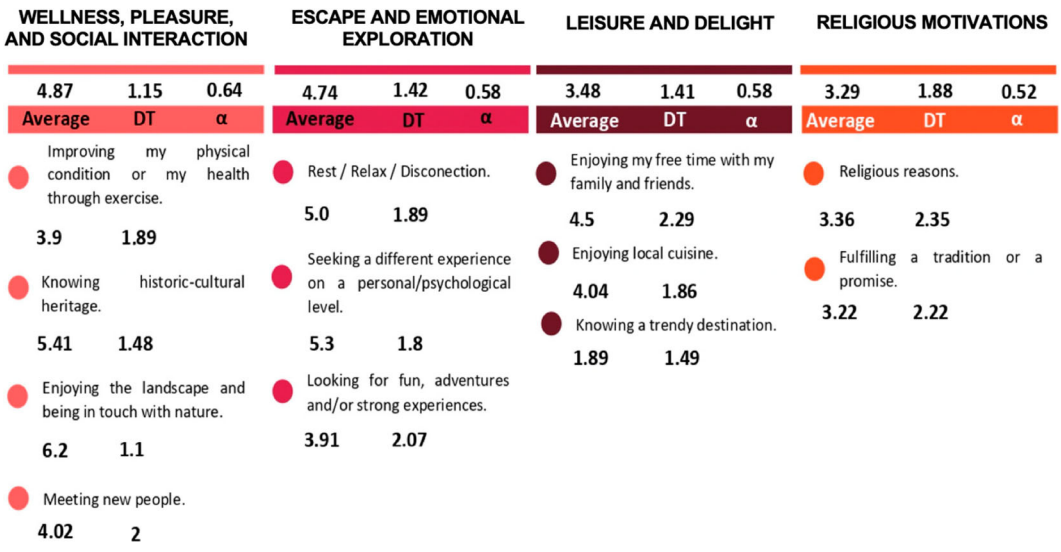

Figure 6. Visual representation of the components of pilgrims' motivations. Source: Own elaboration.

Table 3. Cluster analysis in relation to motivations and basic explanation. Averages of the degree of importance depending on the cluster membership protocol.

MOTIVATIONS	CLUSTERS				
	1 (*n*:188)	2 (*n*:74)	3 (*n*:111)	4 (*n*:41)	*P*-value
Rest / Relax / Disconnection	5.35	5.30	5.04	2.78	0.00
Seeking a different experience on a personal/psychological level	5.16	5.93	5.87	3.27	0.00
Religious reasons	1.97	2.65	5.09	6.29	0.00
Improving my physical condition or my health through exercise	4.13	2.85	4.50	3.15	0.00
Knowing historic-cultural heritage	5.52	4.66	5.98	4.73	0.00
Enjoying the landscape and being in touch with nature	6.32	5.77	6.57	5.05	0.00
Looking for fun, adventures and/or strong experiences	4.56	2.96	4.33	1.54	0.00
Enjoying my free time with my family and friends	5.97	1.91	4.51	2.37	0.00
Enjoying local cuisine	4.59	2.26	4.83	2.66	0.00
Fulfilling a tradition or a promise	2.56	2.18	4.25	5.34	0.00
Meeting new people	3.80	3.42	5.19	2.95	0.00
Knowing a trendy destination	2.03	1.28	2.29	1.22	0.00
Wellness, pleasure, and social interaction	**5.0248**	**4.7297**	**5.0811**	2.5285	0.00
Escape and emotional exploration	2.2633	2.4122	4.6712	**5.8171**	0.00
Leisure and delight	**4.9428**	4.1757	**5.5586**	3.9695	0.00
Religious motivations	**4.1968**	1.8153	3.8769	2.0813	0.00

Source: Own elaboration.

clusters has been used. This technique is multivariate in nature and allows population to be classified into a small number of mutually exclusive and exhaustive groups, without taking into account possible dependencies between the variables.

This step in the analysis was performed by using the hierarchical grouping method through the measure of Squared Euclidean distance under the Ward method (minimum variance within the cluster). This procedure serves for identifying relatively homogeneous groups of cases among the characteristics indicated, this time the motivations, through an algorithm that begins with each case in a different cluster and combines the clusters until only one remains.

Thus, the results of the cluster analysis detect the formation of 4 different groups (Table 3), where group 1 and group 3 were those that resulted in a higher accumulation of frequency. Next, the averages of the motivations were evaluated according to the cluster membership protocol to study in depth their behaviour, as shown in the following table.

In a descriptive analysis of the groups created around the differences between the scores for the different motivations, it can be observed that all groups are featured by giving high scores in the factors of 'wellness, pleasure, and social interaction' and 'escape and emotional exploration'. However, group 3 is the one that stands out from the rest in the percentage assessments of these motivations and group 4 scores with the highest degree of importance the motivational factor 'spiritual and evasion'. Likewise, it should be noted that those who are most far from religious motivations are group 2.

Regarding the preferential activities, it is observed in Table 4 that group 1 is mostly identified with the activities: playing sports, discovering and experiencing and appreciating the diversity of the landscape, participating in scientific activities. The group 2 seems to relatively identified with purchasing handicrafts and attending religious events. Group 3 is identified in greater proportion with those who like to carry out activities related to thermalism and go on gastronomic routes. Finally, group 4 is interested in participating in activities related to agriculture or livestock, attending cultural events and activities, participating in craft workshops or learning other languages.

Cluster 1 is mostly identified with activities: playing sports, discovering and experiencing and appreciating the diversity of the landscape, participating in scientific activities. Cluster 2 seems to relatively feel more identified with purchasing handicrafts and attending religious events. Cluster 3 is identified in greater proportion with those who like to carry out activities related to thermalism and go to gastronomic routes. Cluster 4 is interested in participating in activities related to

Table 4. Preference of activities based on the membership cluster protocol.

Activities	Conglomerados/Clusters				
	1 (n:188)	2 (n:74)	3 (n:111)	4 (n:41)	*P*-value
Participating in activities related to agriculture or livestock	2.1%	1.4%	2.7%	9.8%	0.04
Doing sports (hiking, mountaineering, white-water rafting, caving, horse riding, etc.)	46.8%	24.3%	34.2%	14.6%	0.00
Discovering, experiencing and appreciating the diversity of the landscape, flora and fauna	91.0%	82.4%	88.3%	80.5%	0.12
Carrying out activities related to thermalise	10.6%	6.8%	10.8%	4.9%	0.53
Attending cultural events and activities (museums, exhibitions, etc.)	35.6%	41.9%	49.5%	51.2%	0.07
Going to gastronomic tours	17.6%	5.4%	18.0%	12.2%	0.06
Participating in activities related to agriculture or livestock	9.6%	4.1%	7.2%	14.6%	0.22
Participating in scientific or academic activities (congresses, seminars, courses, etc.)	50.5%	31.1%	45.0%	31.7%	0.01
Purchasing handicrafts and / or typical products	10.6%	23.0%	21.6%	17.1%	0.03
Learning another language	26.6%	40.5%	67.6%	73.2%	0.00
Attending religious events (masses, pilgrimages, local festivals, etc.)	15.4%	18.9%	9.9%	14.6%	0.36

Source: Own elaboration.

agriculture or livestock, attending cultural events and activities, participating in craft workshops or learning other languages.

On the other hand, based on the analysed sociodemographic characteristics and activities carried out (Table 5), a description of the composition of each cluster can be determined, which have been named as follows, based mainly on the age range.

The G1 GENERATION Z, tourists: it predominates because it is a group composed of young people (18-24 years old), in this case they are Students of Autonomous Origin (Galicia), with motivations in

Table 5. Cluster behaviour based on sociodemographic characteristics.

Sociodemographic variables	Conglomerates/Clusters				
	1 (n:188)	2 (n:74)	3 (n:111)	4 (n:41)	*P*-value
Sex					0.10
Male	50.0%	48.6%	49.5%	29.3%	
Female	50.0%	51.4%	50.5%	70.7%	
Age					0.00
18–24	26.6%	8.1%	5.4%	0.0%	
25–34	18.1%	17.6%	7.2%	4.9%	
35–44	13.3%	14.9%	7.2%	4.9%	
45–54	15.4%	18.9%	19.8%	19.5%	
55–64	17.6%	20.3%	34.2%	31.7%	
Over 65	9.0%	20.3%	26.1%	39.0%	
Educational Level					0.03
Illiterate	0.5%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	
Elementary	1.1%	0.0%	3.6%	2.4%	
Secondary School (Vocational Training/High School diploma)	21.8%	13.5%	33.3%	34.1%	
University Degree	76.6%	86.5%	63.1%	63.4%	
Employment Status					0.00
Self-employed	14.4%	13.5%	12.6%	22.0%	
Unemployed	4.3%	1.4%	1.8%	0.0%	
Retired	11.2%	28.4%	35.1%	43.9%	
Employed	39.9%	39.2%	45.0%	34.1%	
Student	30.3%	17.6%	5.4%	0.0%	
Monthly Salary					0.03
Low	17.0%	16.2%	10.8%	0.0%	
Medium-Low	16.0%	18.9%	8.1%	9.8%	
Medium	48.9%	41.9%	57.7%	56.1%	
Medium-High	16.5%	17.6%	21.6%	29.3%	
High	1.6%	5.4%	1.8%	4.9%	

Source: Own elaboration.

doing activities related to sports (hiking, mountaineering, white-water rafting, caving, horse riding, etc.), participating in scientific or academic activities (congresses, seminars, courses, etc.), and are those who have less interest in activities related to purchasing handicrafts and/or typical products and, curiously, less interest in learning languages.

The G2 MILLENIALS AND BOOMERS, the experiential ones: With more varied ages (from 25 years to > = 65 years), they are usually university students and, although it is not significant in terms of differences in comparison with the rest of the groups, they are the ones with the highest level of income. Of international origin, and with less interest in scientific or academic activities (congresses, seminars, courses, etc.) than the rest of the groups, they do not position themselves in a specific activity and tend to be distributed among several.

The G3 YOUNGER SENIOR, the traveller: This group is made up of visitors between 55 and 64, pensioners or retirees, who come from Spain and Europe – as in the case of the G4 – and with training in Vocational Training / High School. They are the group with the lowest number of university students, although they are motivated to learn languages.

The G4 OLDER SENIOR, the pilgrims: Composed of visitors > = 65 years, where retirees / pensioners predominate and are clearly those who have a lower income. Of Spanish origin, the activities that motivate them to participate are linked to agriculture or livestock and language learning. They show little interest in doing sports (hiking, mountaineering, white-water rafting, caving, horse riding, etc.).

The results shown above confirm that pilgrimage routes, despite being strongly associated with religion, are not limited to the field of religious practices (Øian, 2019) but are rather an experiential tourism (Lois González & Santos, 2015). Although historically a pilgrim was described as a person who walked to a sanctuary with religious motivations, today pilgrims travel for many other reasons (Oviedo et al., 2014). Travellers today live and express their religiosity in a more personal and interpretative way, which embraces or includes, rather than excludes, the cultural and natural aspects of the Camino (Kim et al., 2019). The current analysis is based on the concept of 'polymorphic religious tourism', which integrates different ways of motivating tourists to visit various destinations (Tsironis, 2022).

5.3. Empirical contributions to the analytical distinction between pilgrim-tourist on the Camino de Santiago

On pilgrimage routes it is possible to find pilgrims and tourists, each with a personal motivation, carrying out divergent or convergent activities, but at different times these actors intersect and relate in different ways. The Camino de Santiago, as a polysemic phenomenon, is associated with cultural, historical and spiritual meanings rather than exclusively religious meanings (Kim et al., 2019) and, in this sense, it is difficult today to distinguish between pilgrims and tourists (Abad-Galzacorta et al., 2016).

The variable shown in Figure 7 has been based on Smith's continuum (1992). Respondents were asked which option best defined their experience on the Camino, choosing from 'pilgrim', 'pilgrim > tourist', 'pilgrim = tourist', 'pilgrim < tourist', and 'tourist'. The results indicate a decompensation between the self-identified categories of 'pilgrim', that account for 71.3% of the total, and 'tourist', which represent 10.4%, while 18.3% declare themselves undecided.

After this identification variable has been applied, the cluster previously made based on the motivations and the results obtained (Table 6) allow the following interpretations:

- The G1 (GENERATION Z) is formed by tourists (pilgrim less than tourist and tourists) along with those who are considered as pilgrims as tourists. It is quite plain they are the ones who are least linked to pilgrims.
- The G2 (MILLENIALS AND BOOMERS), is the most linked to the pilgrim experience.
- The G3 (YOUNGER SENIOR) is more blurred and is not clearly defined in the type of traveller, but it makes clear its antagonism with the tourist.
- The G4 (SENIOR) that, together with the G2, is more defined as a pilgrim.

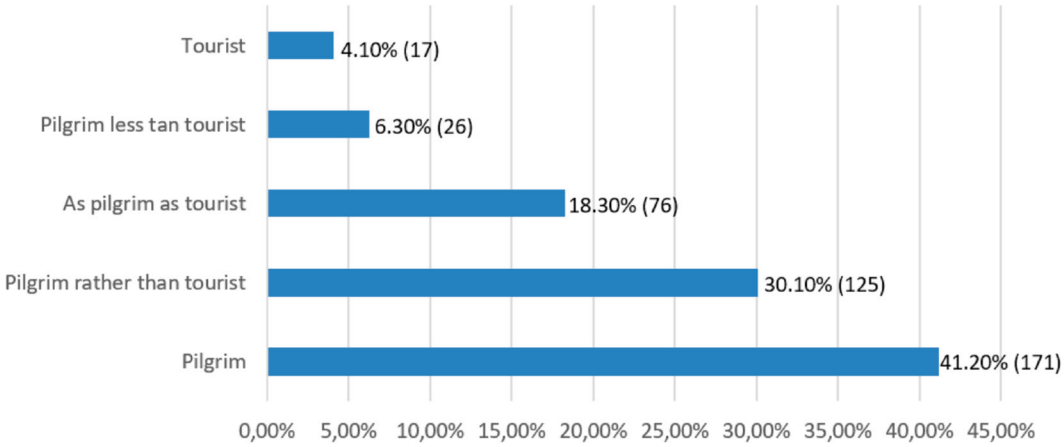

Figure 7. Identification on the Tourist-Pilgrim continuum. Source: Own elaboration.

It is noticed that the original classification of the tourist-pilgrim continuum is too broad and, therefore, the variable has been recoded into three response categories (undecided, pilgrim and tourist) whose distribution, confirms the tendency to position itself in the pilgrim section for 72%, followed by the undecided with 18% and, finally, 10% who clearly consider themselves tourists.

After reorganising the categories provided by Smith's continuum (1992) into 3 groups, a ranking or ordering of the predictor variables in order of importance in classifying these travellers is obtained through a discriminant analysis. Wilks' lamdba test statistic 0.977 indicates that 2 discriminant functions will serve to predict group membership and, based on these considerations, for the construction of the discriminant function, only 3 variables were included*: religious reasons, enjoying free time with my family and or friends and fulfilling a tradition or a promise*.

Based on these considerations, *religious motives and fulfilling a tradition* are the most significant variables based on the respective canonical correlations (0.33 and 0.15) which indicate only the priority of these two discriminating functions in a significant way to allow classifying the subjects in the tourist, undecided and pilgrim groups. Thus, it is determined that *religious motives and fulfilling a tradition or promise* are positioned to define the pilgrim while *enjoying free time with family or friends* defines the undecided.

In short, the contemporary pilgrimage to Santiago de Compostela is shown as an expression of new forms of spirituality and, in this way, the most traditional sacred meaning of this pilgrimage route is changing (Nilsson, 2018). While many pilgrims are motivated by religion or devotion, others are attracted by reasons linked to a more secular, historical, artistic or cultural interest (Di Giovine & Choe, 2019).

In any case, pilgrims should not be considered a homogeneous group (Amaro et al., 2018) since the reasons are particularly biographical and difficult to generalise. That is to say, each individual has their particular reasons and organise them in a specific way (Pereiro, 2019).

Next, in Figure 8, the results are visually collected by relating them to Smith's continuum (1992). This broad spectrum reflects the travellers' multiple and changing motivations, whose interests and

Table 6. Table of the crossing of the clusters with the self-identification of the 5 categories of traveller.

	Cluster				
Self-identification	1 (n:18)	2 (n:74)	3 (n:11)	4 (n:41)	
Options that define your experience doing the Camino					*p*-value = 0.00
Pilgrim	26.6%	60.8%	45.0%	63.4%	
Pilgrim rather than tourist	31.4%	23.0%	33.3%	29.3%	
Pilgrim less than tourist	24.5%	8.1%	18.9%	4.9%	
Tourist	11.2%	1.4%	2.7%	2.4%	
	6.4%	6.8%	0.0%	0.0%	

Source: Own elaboration.

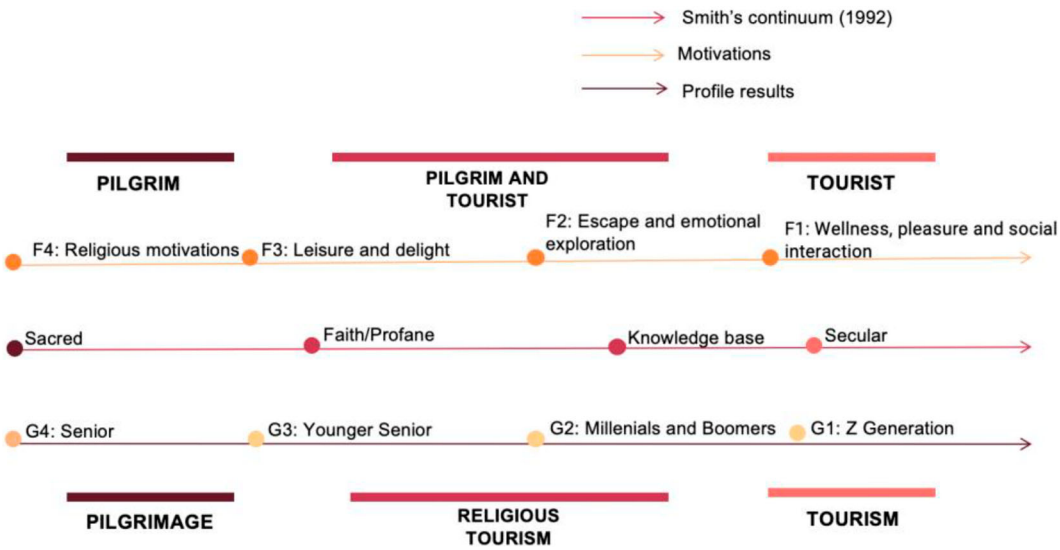

Figure 8. Analytical distinction between pilgrim-tourist on the Camino de Santiago from motivations and self-denomination according to Smith's continuum (1992). Source: Own elaboration.

activities could shift (consciously or unconsciously) from pilgrimage to tourism and vice versa (Millán Vázquez & y Pérez, 2017) even if the individual does not notice the change (Smith, 1992). There can be religious motivations and other types of tourist motivations simultaneously and they can also complement to each other (Liro et al., 2018b).

Under these considerations, the Camino de Santiago, an icon of the pilgrimages of our time, has aroused growing interest and attracts travellers from a wide variety of religious and spiritual affiliations (Nilsson, 2018). For some, the Camino de Santiago remains essentially a religious route, but for the majority, spiritual, scenic, heritage motivations or simply a taste for returning to slow mobility are the fundamental impetus for heading to Santiago (Somoza Medina & Lois González, 2017)

6. Conclusions

The data obtained through this research have allowed us to explore how pilgrimage routes are experienced by those who travel them. As already mentioned, there are many authors who have tried to define and address the concepts of tourism and pilgrimage, from the well-known continuum established by Smith (1992) to classic authors such as Cohen (1979), Nolan and Nolan (1992) or Turner and Turner (1978), among others.

The model proposed for the analyses allowed to characterise the pilgrims who do the Camino de Santiago. In this way, it is discovered that a high percentage of them repeat the experience (70%); which is an activity that is usually done on foot (almost 90%) and with other people (77.7%). In addition, and according to the sample, the hostel is usually the type of accommodation chosen (by 77.1%) and the average daily expenditure is usually below € 35 (for 43%). Regarding the activities they do, experiencing and appreciating the diversity of the landscape, the flora and fauna is (87.7%) the main option by far.

However it is necessary to recognise that the differences between these two groups are fading as they merge and many similarities begin to emerge (Collins-Kreiner, 2010a) and we cannot, therefore, distinguish places as unequivocally as tourist or pilgrimage destinations (Nilsson, 2018). As the boundaries between pilgrimage and tourism have become blurred, there is a need to find a more holistic way to understand the nuances of the pilgrimage-tourism relationship (Polus et al., 2022).

The study identifies and evaluates four main motivations that lead to the Camino de Santiago and that could predictably be extrapolated to other pilgrimage routes: well-being and pleasure; spirituality and avoidance; socialisation and entertainment; and religious motives. Likewise, four profiles of pilgrims were distinguished that, based on their sociodemographic characteristics and the activities they carried out, were called: G1, Generation Z 'the tourists'; G2, Millennials and Boomers 'the experientials'; G3, Younger Senior 'the travellers'; G4, Senior 'the pilgrims'. While the first ones are mostly identified with sports, the enjoyment of the landscape and participation in scientific activities, the second ones opt for purchasing handicrafts and attending religious events; the third party prefer activities related to thermalism and gastronomy; and the last ones prefer agriculture or livestock, attending cultural events and activities, language learning and participating in craft workshops.

According to the proposal of Smith's continuum (1992), it was observed that G1 was the most 'tourist' and least 'pilgrim', and that this relationship is gradually reversed as one moved towards the G4 group, the most 'pilgrim' and least 'tourist'. However, the results achieved in this section have been very revealing since, although Kim et al. (2019) confirmed that the Camino is best associated with point (b) of Smith's continuum, where its adherents are more religious or spiritual pilgrims than purely secular tourists in this case it should be pointed out that this fact varies according to age. In fact, the results corroborate other research such as that by Oviedo et al. (2014) who found a significant correlation between age and religious motivations. Thus, younger generations are more keen on secular experiences and, conversely, Older Seniors are more fond of religious experiences. In addition, those motivations closest to 'well-being and pleasure' are associated with those who consider themselves more tourists and, therefore, more secular; and, on the opposite side we find the most religious motivations, which are located in the section of the sacred and would be the purely pilgrim self-considered.

In short, the reasons that lead pilgrims to undertake the journey seem to be dynamic and changing (Moscarelli et al., 2020). Under these considerations and reflection of the modern multi-religious and multicultural European society (Lois González & Santos, 2015), pilgrimages are perceived as 'hyper-significant' (Di Giovine & Choe, 2019), complex, open, polysemic and with different implications and intersections at the religious, political, social, cultural, economic, environmental and territorial levels (Lois González & Lopez, 2012; Moscarelli et al., 2020).

Previously, sanctuaries were only sacred buildings visited mainly by people with religious motivations (pilgrims). Nowadays, pilgrimage centres are developed with multiple buildings (called sacred complexes or religious-recreational parks), offering additional cultural and tourist facilities for visitors with diverse motivations (pilgrims, religious tourists, and tourists in the traditional meaning) (Sołjan & Liro, 2022).

Thus, in Santiago de Compostela, traditional religion (institutional, organised) and post-secular (personal or individualised forms of religious beliefs) are mixed in multiple ways (Nilsson & Tesfahuney, 2016). Tourism, pilgrimage, religion, and spirituality mix in an ever changing manner, at both the individual and societal level. This does not mean that overarching concepts can never be achieved, but that they must be nuanced to match the complex reality of what they are trying to understand (Polus et al., 2022).

In any case, as Nolan and Nolan (1992) point out, different categories of religious destinations attract different kinds of visitors, each in search of different experiences (Millán & Pérez, 2017), that is to say, it should also be considered that not all sacred destinations attract both tourists and pilgrims equally (Olsen & Timothy, 2006). Pilgrimage as an institution cannot today be understood as a universal and homogeneous phenomenon, but should be deconstructed in specific historical and cultural circumstances (Coleman, 2002). For this reason, it is necessary to make a transversal and longitudinal replica in other pilgrimage routes and in different periods of time where we also should go in depth in the understanding of the pilgrimage as a scene for religious.

Note

1. The Xacobeos (Jacobean) correspond to the Holy Years celebrated by the Catholic Church when the day of Santiago (July 25) falls on a Sunday. In this period, plenary indulgence is granted to the faithful who visit the tomb of the Apostle, confess and commune in the cathedral that bears his name (Herrero Pérez, 2008).

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